

FALL FORCE

Fall-winter marks a full house as the industry top liners return and the FDCI strives to create order from chaos

REUBEN SINGH

■ By Kimi Dangor

An Indian autumn reigned as Amar Chitra Katha met Minnie Mouse at Manish Arora's autumn-winter 2008 ready-to-wear show on the opening day at Paris Fashion Week (PFW) in February. And even as Arora's warriors conquered the couture crowd, fashion watchers in the French capital were floored as biker chic and the sari drape combined in a Rossi Meets Mother Teresa line (after the biking champion Rossi) by Rajesh Pratap Singh. While the Parisian spring-summer showing last year saw Anamika Khanna take a bow, Ashish Soni took a sizeable bite of the Big Apple at the New York Fashion Week. Now, having made the fashionable cut at the style meccas of the world, our winsome warriors are back on desi trend terrain. The forthcoming Autumn-Winter 2008 edition of the Wills Lifestyle India Fashion Week (WIFW), beginning March 12 to 16, will see the red carpet being rolled out for Indian fashion's finest headliners.

Psychedelic samurais and modern-day geishas will meet environmental warriors as India goes to the fashion floorboards for yet another season of autumn-winter arrivals at Pragati Maidan, Delhi. Leading the pack are Soni and Khanna, who present their distinctly divergent statements at the Wills Grand Finale. Fall also marks the ramp return of J.J. Valaya who launches his all new ready-to-wear line Valaya Base as Rohit Gandhi and Rahul Khanna literally take a 'cue' and



PARAS AND SHALINI Geisha Designs' collection Dandy, a Synthesis line, captures the eccentricities of the rich and famous.

"Pointed stilettos and ankle length boots reflect the indulgent mood of fall."